

# Microsoft 365 Troubleshooting Guide

Field guide: authentication, mail flow, OneDrive/SharePoint, Teams

Document ID: BVT-RUN-054

Version: 1.0

Issued: July 02, 2026

Effective Date: \_\_\_\_\_

## Authentication / Sign-In Issues

| Symptom                               | Check                                                                                     | Fix                                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 'Password incorrect' but user is sure | Sign-in logs: is it actually CA block, risky sign-in, or bad password?<br>Account locked? | Address the real cause: unlock, reset with identity verification, clear risk state, or fix CA policy           |
| MFA loop / can't complete MFA         | New phone? Authenticator moved?<br>Time sync on TOTP?                                     | Verify identity per BVT-OPS-028 procedure, then reset MFA methods and re-register; issue Temporary Access Pass |
| 'AADSTS50076 / 53003' errors          | Conditional Access policy match — which policy in sign-in log?                            | Adjust policy scoping or bring device into compliance (join/enroll)                                            |
| Repeated password prompts in Outlook  | Modern auth enabled? Cached credentials stale? Profile corruption?                        | Clear Credential Manager entries; new Outlook profile; verify legacy auth not being attempted                  |
| Sudden org-wide sign-in failures      | Service health (admin center / status page); recent CA change?                            | Roll back last CA/identity change via break-glass account; open MS ticket; communicate per SLA                 |

## Mail Flow

| Symptom                            | Check                                                                                         | Fix                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Inbound mail missing               | Message trace (EAC) — delivered, quarantined, or never arrived? MX records correct?           | Release/allow from quarantine with justification; fix transport rule; correct DNS                    |
| Outbound going to recipients' spam | SPF/DKIM/DMARC alignment (headers of a received copy); IP/domain reputation; content triggers | Fix DNS auth records; register with Microsoft SNDS/postmaster tools; adjust content; warm reputation |
| NDR 550 5.7.x rejections           | Read the exact NDR code — auth failure vs policy vs blocklist                                 | Targeted per code: delist, fix auth, request recipient allowlist                                     |
| Mail delayed                       | Message trace 'defer' events; service health; oversized attachments                           | Vendor issue: monitor + inform; local issue: fix transport rule/size limits                          |
| User 'not receiving' one sender    | Junk folder, inbox rules (user AND admin-visible), blocked senders, quarantine                | Remove rogue rule (also check for BEC artifacts!), allow sender via tenant list                      |

## OneDrive / SharePoint

| Symptom                              | Check                                                                                             | Fix                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sync stuck / red X                   | Client up to date? Path length >400 chars? Invalid characters? Library too large?                 | Update client, reset OneDrive (onedrive /reset), shorten paths, unsync huge libraries and use web/shortcuts |
| 'You need permission' on shared file | Actual permission level; link type (specific people vs org); external sharing settings            | Re-share correctly; adjust site external-sharing level per policy                                           |
| Deleted files                        | Recycle bin (1st + 2nd stage = 93 days); Restore your OneDrive (30-day rollback); backup platform | Restore in order: recycle bin → point-in-time restore → M365 backup                                         |
| Version needed of overwritten file   | Version history on the item                                                                       | Restore prior version; educate on co-authoring instead of copies                                            |

## Teams

- Call/meeting quality: run per-user call analytics; check local network (WiFi vs wired, QoS, bandwidth) before blaming service.
- Sign-in issues: clear Teams cache (%appdata%\Microsoft\Teams or new-Teams reset), verify license, check CA device requirements.
- Missing team/channel: confirm membership and that the team isn't archived; check group in Entra.

Golden rules: (1) message trace and sign-in logs before guessing; (2) check Service Health before deep-diving org-wide issues; (3) any 'mail missing + inbox rule found' = treat as possible BEC and run BVT-IRP-047.